i held your camera like a bible (wishin' so bad that it held some kind of truth)

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/48307675.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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F/F, F/M

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra)

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Catra (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Scorpia (She-Ra), Entrapta (She-Ra)

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by Tineye1

Summary

"You know, Adora's had a huge crush on you since like, eighth grade."

Catra bluescreened for a moment. "Adora?"

"Yeah, you know. Tall, blonde, hopeless in social situations, makes goo-goo eyes at you every time you walk past her in the hallway?" Glimmer responded.

"Gli- I know who the fuck Adora is. She has a what on me?"

Notes

this work was inspired by two things: first, "Old Soul Song (For the New World Order)" by Bright Eyes; and second, the fic "someone you like" by caela (which is way better than this one and you should go read it if you haven't already)

honestly i just rode the vibes to the end

See the end of the work for more notes

- Inspired by someone you like by caela

Catra knows of Adora. Fuck, everyone and their mother knows of Adora. She has twenty five thousand instagram followers and a little posse that called themselves the þrincess alliance' (seriously , how dorky can you get), and everyone wants to know her, be friends with her, or be her. The instagram account isnt even that interesting. t' s half pictures of her and her dorky friends (mostly the shredded guy who wears crop tops and the angry girl with pink hair) and half pictures of landscapes, or a white truck. All the images are perfectly framed, and the captions read like a shitty inspirational poster on the wall of a cubicle. The fact that Catra and Adora are in the same grade, and even in some of the same classes, didnt mean they would ever interact. Adora was editor-in-chief of the yearbook, and president of the photography club, while Catra smoked weed in the stairwells with Scorp and fucked around on school laptops with T rapta. As far as the school was concerned, her and Adora lived in different worlds.

So when Catra got partnered with one of Adora's friends, Glimmer, on a science proþect, she didnt think anything of it. Actually , once her and Glimmer stopped trying to piss each other off by using shitty nicknames for each other (Catra still called her Sparkles sometimes, þst to keep her on her toes) they found that they actually worked pretty well together. Catra was a hard worker, but often ended up burning herself out by trying be perfect (probably a symptom of her shitty upbringing, like most things in her life), while Glimmer tempered her by being more laid back, but still stubborn when it came to taking breaks and being realistic. They finished the proþect, and even Catra thought they did a pretty good þb, with her high standards. So, once they were done, she thought they would go their separate ways as friendly acqaintances. But on the last day of the proþect, Glimmer had something very interesting to say .

"Y ou know, Adora's had a huge crush on you since like, eighth grade."

Catra bluescreened for a moment. "Adora?"

"Yeah, you know. Tall, blonde, hopeless in social situations, makes goo-goo eyes at you every time you walk past her in the hallway?" Glimmer responded.

"Gli- I know who the fuck Adora is. She has a *what* on me?"

Catra was bewildered. She wasn't aware Adora knew she existed until about seven seconds ago, and now apparently she had a crush on Catra. Since middle school.

"Look, don't tell her I told you. She thinks it's a secret, but our entire friend group figured it out years ago. I'm just saying, you have a chance if you want it."

"You want me to believe that I have a chance with Adora. The one who hasn't dated at all since she came out? Are you fucking kidding me?"

"I'm gonna be honest, I wasn't sure why either. But, after doing this project with you, I kinda see what she sees. I mean, I'm locked down, but I'm also bi as hell and I never questioned her interest in the looks department. It was more the 'everything else' department I was worried about."

Catra is about to absolutely lose it. Glimmer dropped this insane statement on her head like, three minutes before they were supposed to part ways forever, and now all Catra can think about is how she might have a chance with Adora and her stupid little hair poof. Catra wasn't fucking blind, okay? As much as she loathed Adora for her social standing and general positivity, not even Catra could deny that Adora was hot. She just never entertained the possibility of them having anything to do with each other until now.

"Well what the fuck am I supposed to do now?" Catra asked in a furious whisper. "I can't just ask her out! Do you know how many people would come for my head if she said yes? Every lesbian in the damn school wants to date her!"

"I'm not saying you need to ask her out right away," Glimmer answered, noticeably calmer than Catra. "She's certainly not interested in anyone else."

"Oh, well that's a relief," Catra said sarcastically, starting to pack up her lab notebook and clean up their lab table. "Could you help me with this? I have calc in like, five minutes, and Dr. Hordak threatened to drop a letter grade on my next test if I'm late again."

"Hordak's a bastard," Glimmer grumbled, starting to wash the beakers they had used for their tests that day. "There was a problem on last night's derivative homework with like, four chain rules in it. Fuckin' annoying."

"Tell me about it," Catra said as she finished packing her backpack. "Look, I gotta think about the Adora thing. I'm not sure if I can handle that stuff right now."

"You could come with us to stargaze this Friday," Glimmer offered. "We usually take Adora's truck up to a lookout point on Mount Etheria after school and hang out until the sun sets. It'll be low stakes, and you can invite Scorpia and Entrapta if you want. Bow always likes meeting new people, and Adora will probably be too excited about you coming to even notice."

Catra was a little shocked. Both at Glimmer actually inviting her and her weird friends to what sounded like something of a tradition for the three of them, and also at how excited she was at the prospect. Catra rarely wanted to hang out with friends. Once she actually got herself to do it, she usually had fun, but getting herself to go was usually difficult.

"I'll ask them. Thank y- thanks for the invite."

"No problem. Text me when you decide and we'll work out the details later. See you around, Catra."

*

s c o r p

hey

you know my lab partner glimmer?

Yeah!She’ s friends with Bow and Adora, right?

yeah

she invited me

well

us

to stargaze on mount etheria this friday

Wildcat!That’ s awesome!

so do you and trapta want to go

Do you want to go?

um

yeah

kind of a lot, actually

Then well go. :)

*

They decided to take their own car. Partly because they were more comfortable making the drive themselves, and partly because Scorpia clearly wanted to talk to Catra on the way up the mountain.

"You don't have to come just because I want to, Scorp. I can make it up there by myself." Catra says as they walk to Scorpia's old SUV

"I want to! Bow is in my team sports class this semester, and he's really cool! And you know Entrapta will talk about the stars for as long as anyone will listen. Besides, I'm proud of you for coming out of your shell a little."

Catra slides quickly into the backseat so Scorpia can't see her blush. "Thanks, Scorp."

Entrapta slides into the passenger seat. "I'm just excited to test out my new telescope! This one has twelve times the magnification of the last one I built. I wanna try to see the strata on Saturn's rings!"

Catra laid down in the backseat, slid in one of her earbuds, and listened to Scorpia and Entrapta's quiet chatting for the rest of the way up the mountain.

*

Adora's truck was already parked at the lookout point when they got there. Bow was unpacking blankets and a picnic basket, while Glimmer was sitting in the front seat with the door open fiddling with something. Adora stood near the overlook with her camera out taking pictures of the view as the sun dipped lower in the sky.

Scorpia pulled the car into a parking spot and they all hopped out. Entrapta went to take her telescope out of the trunk, while Scorpia rushed to help Bow unload the truck.

Catra walked over to Glimmer. "Are you - is that weed?"

"Yeah." Glimmer sat in the front seat of the truck rolling joints. "You want some? Stargazing is always better when you're high."

"Maybe later. Let me keep my wits for a little bit at least."

"I don't blame you." Glimmer nodded her head towards Adora, who was looking through the viewfinder of her camera at the setting sun. "Go say hi. She's really excited, you know."

Catra wandered over to the overlook. "Hey, Adora," she said in a small voice, barely loud enough to be heard over the light breeze rustling the trees.

Adora lowered her camera and turned toward Catra, a nervous smile on her face. "Catra. I'm really glad you could make it."

Catra looked at Adora with a smile on her face, a halo of light around her from the setting sun behind her, and thought she'd never seen anything more beautiful in her entire life.

*

So, they talked. Her and Adora. Sometimes Glimmer, Bow, Scorpia, and Entrapta or a combination of the four would come by and get caught up in the conversation, but her and Adora laid on the roof of the truck with a couple pints to share and talked for hours. Talking with Adora felt like coming home to a familiar apartment after a day of work. It felt like finally getting a breath of fresh air after being stuck in a stuffy building for hours. It felt more natural than anything in the entire world, which was fucking weird because they hadn't spoke more than three words to one another in the last four years of high school. But Catra certainly wasn't complaining.

"So why do you take so many pictures, anyway?" Catra asks. Throughout the night, Adora had periodically slipped away to take pictures of the group, or pictures of the stars and the town below them. "It clearly goes beyond just being an extracurricular."

Adora thought for a moment, taking a drag of the pint. "My life was… not great before. Before Glimmer's parents adopted me, I mean. When I remember those times, I remember how much worse life can be than it is now. I guess I'm scared that this might be the best my life is gonna get. Like, I have all these friends that I love, and I have

hobbies and family, and Im worried that itll all be gone someday . And when that someday comes, Iwant to be able to remember the good times."

"Hm. Reminds me of a song lyric, actually ."

"Oh really? Sing it for me, please?"

Catra snorts quietly . "It' s pretty short, but okay." She took a deep breath, and began to sing quietly:

And one day we will die

And our ashes will fly

From the aeroplane over the sea

But for now we are young

Let us lay in the sun

And count every beautiful thing we can see

"That' s beautiful, Catra. And that's not just the weed talking."

"Thanks. That song' s gotten me through some tough times."

"Hey , so usually after these stargazing nights Bow stays over with Glimmer and Iat our house. W ould you, Scorpia and Entrapta want to do that too? Y ou dont have to, of course, but our house is right at the base of the mountain, so the drive is a lot shorter. Plus, Micah always makes a really good breakfast."

"W ell, Entrapta doesnt do sleepovers, something about tracking her sleeping habits. Scorpia usually has family brunch with her moms on Saturday mornings, so shell probably prefer to sleep at home too. Ill ask her in case, though." Catra slipped of f the roof of the truck and walked over to the telescope where the other four were sitting. Entrapta seemed to be in the middle of describing something called

the Oort cloud to a riveted Glimmer and Bow. Catra walked around to where Scorpia was sitting and asked, "Hey Scorp, could I talk to you for a minute?"

Scorpia hopped up and followed Catra out of earshot of the others. "What's up Wildcat? You and Adora seem to be getting along pretty well." Scorpia asked, along with an extremely unnecessary waggling of her eyebrows.

Catra gave her a friendly shove. "Oh, fuck off. Yeah, we get along great. We get along perfectly and it scares the shit out of me. She invited us over for a sleepover, and I have no fucking idea what to do."

Scorpia thought for a moment. "Well, I've gotta be home for brunch tomorrow morning, and Entrapta can only sleep in her own bed. Are you thinking you want to go and stay over?"

"I don't know, Scorp! This all feels like it's moving too fast, and I'm not sure if what I'm feeling is normal, or even real, and everything seems too perfect to be true. Being with Adora feels better than anything, a-and I wish I could feel like I deserve it."

"Oh Catra," Scorpia said with that voice that meant she was about to say something sappy as fuck. "You do deserve it. Whatever happens, just know that you deserve happiness. If you want to go and sleep over with Adora, then you should! I'm so glad that people other than Entrapta and I are seeing you for who you really are."

Scorpia held her arms out for a hug, and Catra stepped into them, hiding her face in Scorpia's shoulder. "Thanks. I-I think I needed to hear that" Catra said, sounding suspiciously choked up. She stepped out of the hug and quickly scrubbed her arm across her face to hide the few tears that escaped.

"I'm gonna-" she gestured toward where Adora was packing up her truck with Bow and Glimmer. "I'll see you tomorrow?"

"Of course, Wildcat. Text me when you get there so I know you're safe."

*

Bow drove, because he was the only one who wasn't still a little faded from the weed. Glimmer was pretty much completely knocked out in the passenger seat, which left Adora and Catra in the back. Just like Adora said, the drive was much shorter than their drive up from Scorpia's, and the house they pulled up to was pretty fucking massive. Catra must have looked a little taken aback, because Adora noticed her expression.

"Angella is in state government and Micah is a surgeon, so we're pretty well off. They're good people though. You'll see in the morning."Adora whispered, trying not to disturb the peace of the night.

They went inside the house, with Bow basically carrying Glimmer up the front stairs. Adora locked the front door behind them, and they quietly climbed the stairs to the second floor. When they got to the second floor, Adora turned to Catra.

"You can sleep in my room tonight, and I'll bunk with Bow and Glimmer in Glimmer's room."

"Are you sure? I can just sleep on a couch or something. It'll probably still be more comfortable than my bed at home."

"It's fine, I promise! Actually, when Angella and Micah adopted me and I moved in here, I was too scared to sleep in my own room most of the time, so I always slept over with Glimmer. I'm not scared anymore, but we still do it sometimes for fun. Besides, the guest room is on the first floor, and I don't want to wake up Angella and Micah."Adora argued.

Catra relented. "If you're sure, dummy. Lead the way."

Adora led her down the hall and stopped at a door on the left. "Glimmer 's room is down the hall to the right, and there's a bathroom across the hall from her room."Adora opened the door and stepped inside. "This is my room. Sorry , it's kind of a mess."

Catra took a look around. t really wasnt a mess, at least not compared to Catra's own room. One of the walls, though, was covered floor to ceiling with pictures. Some were developed digital photos, and some were polaroids, but they were all clipped to little strands of yarn that zig-zagged up the wall.

"Which one' s your favorite?"Catra asked, walking over to the wall of pictures.

"Hm?"Adora responded, busy grabbing things out of the closet. She turned to see what Catra was looking at.

"asked which one is your favorite. Y ou have to have one, right? mean, some of these are just pictures of your truck."

"Hey!"Adora said, pretending to be of fended. "Swift Wind is a beautiful truck and Itake very good care of him."

"Y ou named your car Swift Wind?"Catra said disbelievingly . "Y ou are such a dork."

"Maybe, but you hung out with this dork all night"

"did. And you know what? d do it again."

Adora sighed. "think my favorite changes all the time. Sometimes, I take a picture and Ithink this one is gonna be my favorite for a really long time', and then Isee an older picture, and all these good memories come rushing back, and all of the sudden that one is my favorite. Right now, though? think my favorite is this one."She points to one high up on the right side of the wall. The photo shows her, Glimmer, and Bow, all with sunglasses on, leaning against Swift Wind. t kinda makes us look like movie stars or something."

Catra smiles at the picture. Adora looks happy in it. "Did you get any good ones tonight?"

"I think I did," Adora responds, a wistful edge to her voice. She shakes her head a little and holds out a pair of shorts and a shirt. "Anyway , You can borrow these for tonight if you want. They're probably a little big on you, but it's just for sleeping, so it should be fine."

Catra takes them, and heads to the bathroom to change. The shirt is too big on her, reaching halfway down her thighs, but the shorts don't fall off her hips, so at least there's that. Before she leaves the bathroom, she makes sure to shoot Scorpia a quick text telling her she's okay.

She returns to Adora's room and sits on Adora's bed. It' s way softer than the one she has at home, and she immediately snuggles into it.

Adora smiles at her. "Okay , well you know where I'll be if you need anything. If not, I'll see you in the morning, okay?" With that, Adora gets up from the side of the bed and starts toward the door.

Catra sits up and grabs Adora's arm as she's leaving. Adora turns to her questioningly , and Catra slides her hand down until they're holding hands. "Adora, wait," Catra looks down at the bed gathering courage, then raises her head to meet Adora's eyes. "Stay?" she asks quietly . Adora's eyes slowly morph into a look of complete adoration.

"For as long as you'll have me."

*

The next day , a new picture was added to Adora's wall. This one showed Catra, sitting on the roof of Adora's truck, silhouetted by the stars, and with the moon shining bright above her head. Adora knew this one would be her favorite for a lot longer than usual.

End Notes

the lyric that catra sings is from "In the Aeroplane Over the Sea" by Neutral Milk Hotel. give it a listen :)

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!